



SpaceX launches rocket

A rocket built by Elon Musk's SpaceX has launched from Earth with two American astronauts. <https://digit.in/jun20-76>



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PANDEMIC-PROOF STARTUPS

These 'Covid-proof' startups are flourishing during the pandemic

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Over two months into the pandemic-induced lockdown in India, the full-fledged ramifications of it are starting to manifest in the startup industry. However, it's not all doom and gloom. Despite the adversities, there are a few startups that are seeing exponential growth fueled by the lockdown. And no, we're not just talking about sanitiser brands. Norms such as work from home, school shutdowns, and increased social welfare and philanthropic spending are actually proving to be a mostly unforeseen boon for

multiple sectors of startups. Let's delve into these fortunate startup sectors that are thriving during the pandemic.

THE SECTORS WITNESSING A MAJOR PUSH

In the wake of the outbreak of COVID-19 in India and the lockdown implementation, sectors such as ed-tech, digital health and digital content saw a perceptible rise. Starting with ed-tech, this sector's graph is going off the charts during the lockdown which has stirred up increased interest from investors. In the very first quarter of 2020, ed-tech startup Byju's raised a whopping \$400 million from General Atlantic and Tiger Global, while Unacademy raised a sizable \$100 million from General Atlantic and Facebook. According to reports, Byju's is set to raise another round at a gargantuan \$10 billion valuation, which is a substantial increase over its last \$8.2 billion round.

So, even in this challenging environment, ed-tech will continue to grow by leaps and bounds since schools and colleges have completely revamped their models of teaching and shifted it online. Numbers don't lie and ed-tech startups have numbers to show. In March, Byju's recorded 6 million new students accessing their lessons, Toppr witnessed a 100 per cent growth in free user engagement, and Unacademy recorded a massive one billion watch minutes. The CEO of Toppr, Zishaan Hayath, told Business Insider that the trend of online education is here to stay since he believes parents will see the merits of



Byju's has seen massive growth in 2020 due to the lockdown